



Gesture control your phone

Touch is so last decade! Real geeks don't prod their phones like baboons, they just gesture! We'll show you how. Just go to

<http://dgit.in/Gesturize>

- Grab the source – this is done using the “Repo” tool and git.
- **Pro Tip:** Have patience.
- Obtain proprietary binaries – some of the drivers are only released in binary form.
- **Pro Tip:** The binary drivers should be unpacked in your working directory.
- Choose a target – using the “lunch” tool.
- **Pro Tip:** This is phone specific and it's better to check out the particular value for your phone.
- Start the build – using “make” and “jack”.
- **Pro Tip:** You start the build using make. GNU make can handle parallel tasks with a -jN argument, and if you find your machine struggles during the build process then try something like “make -j2”.
- Flash the build onto your device – using adb and fastboot.
- **Pro Tip:** You will find adb and fastboot in ./out/host/darwin-x86/bin/ or ./out/host/darwin-x86/bin/ for OS X or Linux respectively.

Once the build is done and flashed, you will be looking at the barebones version of Android on your phone – without Google services and only with few basic apps. Congratulations, you've managed to complete your first basic build of Android.

THE ACTUAL CUSTOMISATION

Tinkering with this huge OS is not an easy feat. Listing out how to build an entirely new custom ROM would take more pages than this entire magazine. A better way to do this would be to

head to <http://dgit.in/AndStsBar> and start off small. Also, if video is your thing, check out the custom ROM tutorials at the links below:

- <http://dgit.in/CstmROM1>
- <http://dgit.in/CstmROM2>

INSTALLING THE BEST

While some of you might have actually tried the build process above, a much more common (and almost as daunting) alternative is to install a popular Custom ROM. On the other hand, if you've followed everything above, installing a custom ROM is fairly simple and involves the following steps:

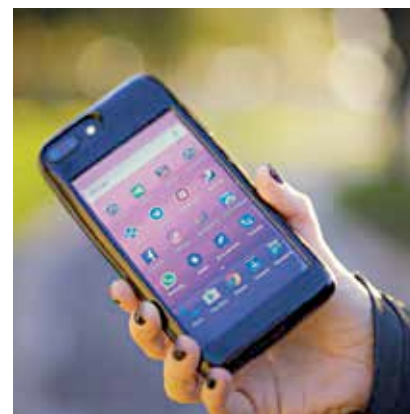
- Download a ROM – Well, duh! Once it is downloaded, place it in your internal memory along with corresponding GApps for the version of Android that you've downloaded.
- Boot into recovery – Checkout the ‘Root your smartphone’ section at the very beginning of this story for a detailed guide on how to set up custom recovery for your smartphone.
- Flash ROM – As mentioned in the ‘Root your smartphone’ section, select the .zip file from the TWRP interface and install it. You can also opt for Clockwork Mod.
- Clear Cache – Once the installation is done, go back and clear your cache. And you're done!

While that's how to get a Custom ROM on your phone, you also need to know which ones are the best. Cyanogenmod is a very popular choice, although Cyanogen Inc shut shop pretty recently. There are some pretty good alternatives which you can check out here: <http://dgit.in/AltCyano>.

With that, you have pretty much learnt how to get a customised version of Android which works exactly the way you want it to.

ACCESSORISE YOUR PHONE

Now that you've rooted your phone it may run like a geek's phone, but does it look like one? You can't really call yourself a geek unless you've tried some accessories on your smartphone. Check out these cool accessories that you can use with your phone to help you get a custom look.



EYE SMART IPHONE CASE

Eye is a very interesting smartphone case, because it has its own OS! You read that right, Eye comes with Android OS on it, but (here's the kicker), it's an iPhone case. Whaaat?! Huh?!? We're not kidding. Eye comes with Android Nougat 7.1 and Google Play. Other features of the Eye smartphone case include a 5-inch Full HD AMOLED display, wireless charging, an added extra 2800mAh of power, 2 SIM slots, up to 256GB of expandable storage, a metal tag for mounting purposes, infrared, a 3.5mm headphone jack and it's NFC enabled. We're pretty sure it can also send stuff to mars, and will kill off humans soon. So what's the point? iPhone one side, flip it and you have Android on the other. How cool is that?



SELFLY

Everyone hates clicking selfies at an arm's length, and selfie sticks are for kids. What you really need is a drone, right? But you can't carry a drone around in your pocket. Or can you? Here's Selfly, a smartphone case that is also a drone! Just snap the drone off the case, and set it to fly. It's even got auto-pilot functionality and will do all the selfie-taking for you.